

JOSEPH CUFFNEY

josephcuffney@gmail.com · 585-503-2714 · Rochester, NY
github.com/jcuffney · linkedin.com/in/cuffney

Professional Summary

Senior software engineer with 10+ years turning ambiguous business problems into production systems — working directly with stakeholders, owning the stack end to end, and shipping 0-to-1 products fast without sacrificing quality. Combined with AI, that experience has exponentially accelerated the impact I can deliver for teams and customers.

Education

Rochester Institute of Technology · B.S. Computer Science · Rochester, NY

Experience

Coinbase · Senior Software Engineer

January 2022 – Present · Remote

Capital Formation (Raise)

- Led a ten-engineer team to launch a capital formation platform enabling IPOs, private equity, and token sales.
- Worked cross-functionally with product, design, marketing, legal, ops, and business to define and refine our solution.
- Delivered the product and went to production in 2 months — raising \$250M+ for our first issuer.

International Exchange

- Led the initial advanced trading build-out for perpetual futures, opening previously unserved international markets.
- Translated legal and regulatory requirements into product decisions, shipping in step with the exchange build-out.
- Owned global rollout — including observability, scaling, and feedback sessions — driving \$1B+ in first-year volume.

GraphQL Federation

- Led a company-wide GraphQL re-architecture, replacing the monolith with a federated graph each team could own.
- Enabled teams to ship faster by owning their own subgraphs, decoupling releases from the shared monolith.
- Built the first subgraph (Go, gqlgen) as the reference, then guided engineers across teams through their migrations.

Nike (Valiant Labs) · Senior Software Engineer III

June 2018 – December 2021 · Portland, OR / Remote

Cultivator

- Built what became Nike By You — a marketplace where 100+ creators sold 500k+ shoes in 1 week.
- Designed an experience that yielded a consistent 13% conversion rate compared to a ~1% industry standard.
- Met directly with creators to understand their needs and motivations, shaping the product around their success.

Nike (Valiant Labs) · Lead Software Engineer (contract)

August 2017 – June 2018 · Portland, OR

Tandem Personal Training

- Solo engineer testing whether trainer accountability could get more people active, driving the Nike flywheel.
- Met with Nike Master Trainer Ryan Flaherty and clients at events we hosted, shaping the product for both sides.
- Owned the build end to end, going from zero to launch in 5 weeks with 100+ trainers onboarded across Portland.

The Program · Technical Lead

October 2015 – August 2017 · Portland, OR

- Led client engagements end to end at a digital agency — scoping, estimating, and delivering across varied stacks.
- Worked directly with clients to turn requirements into shipped products, while mentoring engineers on the team.

Projects

Jarvis Cloud · Voice agent on AWS · 2026

- Voice assistant on Amazon Nova 2 Sonic that delegates deeper work to Claude agents on Bedrock via tool use.
- Wrote an MCP client (stdio and Streamable HTTP) and integrated Home Assistant over WireGuard, Gmail, Google Calendar, and S3 Vectors document knowledge, with a monthly spend cap on model costs.
- Built in two weeks (338 commits): TypeScript and React on CloudFormation, deploying on every push, plus Claude Code jobs dispatched to a LAN devbox through a long-poll work queue.

Assistant · Local-first agent in Rust · 2026

- Rule-based NLP triage, then a ModernBERT classifier labels route, tone, and task — code, not the model, decides.
- Planner → researcher → reporter agents; policies proceed autonomously but escalate to a human when required.
- Built in two days — 12k+ lines of Rust across 9 crates — with an MCP client (rmcp), SearXNG search, guarded web fetch, labeled routing evals, and evals on the CLINC150 intent benchmark.

Orca(stration) AI · From The Forest · 2026

- Building a platform that makes AI agents first-class members of the org chart — Rust microservices on Kubernetes.
- Designed an agentic reasoning loop — autonomous within guardrails, escalating to a human beyond them.
- Built AI budgeting on x402 micropayments, keeping agent spend within budget and ROI measurable.
- Extended LDAP so humans and agents share one directory — teams adopt agents without changing how they work.

LLM Gateway & Homelab Platform · 2026

- LiteLLM gateway: local llama.cpp first, Claude on Bedrock as fallback, per-consumer keys and spend tracking.
- Talos Kubernetes on Proxmox via Terraform and Argo CD, a GPU shared in 4 GB slices, CI-only tenant deploys.
- Self-hosted speech-to-text and text-to-speech, chosen by measured time-to-first-byte and realtime factor.

On Set! · Set-location discovery app · 2020 – 2022

- Co-founded a film set-location app: 2,000+ locations mapped, 200 small-business partners, 1,000 MAU in year one.
- Built the web and React Native apps on an Apollo Federation GraphQL API over AWS Lambda and DynamoDB.

Skills

AI & AGENTS

Claude / OpenAI / Grok Claude Agent SDK MCP Agent orchestration RAG Evals

HARNESSES

Claude Code Codex OpenCode Hermes

NLP

Intent classification (ModernBERT) Semantic analysis & search Embeddings Speech (STT/TTS)

MODELS

AWS Bedrock LiteLLM llama.cpp Ollama Tool use Prompt & tool design

STACK

TypeScript Python Go Rust React Node.js GraphQL (Federation) gRPC REST

CLOUD & INFRA

AWS Kubernetes Argo CD Terraform CloudFormation Proxmox Docker

DATA & TOOLS

Postgres SurrealDB DynamoDB Elasticsearch n8n Datadog Snowflake